



What's in the Glass(Fish)?

Part 1

Well, it's an open source JAVA EE application server.

An application server is a software stack that provides the business logic of a large-scale distributed application. These business logic and business processes are used by other applications running on other computers or that may be running on the same computer. Application servers are used in scenarios where very complex transaction-based applications are continuously running. For the success of any business application, the optimal performance of these servers is very critical. Today, almost all organisations have their own application servers that provide the business processing logic to their applications.

If you look at how Wikipedia defines an application server: "An application server in

an n-tier architecture, is a server that hosts an API to expose business logic and business processes for use by third-party applications. The term can refer to:

1. The services that are made available by the server
2. The computer hardware on which the services are deployed
3. The software framework used to host the services such as the JBoss application server or Oracle application server."

The general architecture of an application server is shown in Figure 1.

The most desirable features of an application server are:

1. Data integrity
2. Load balancing
3. Centralised configuration